



# Geoffrey Brennan

Senior Product Leader — AI & Enterprise SaaS

Product leadership  
built by someone  
who has *modelled the  
process*, designed the  
workflow, and  
shipped the  
software.

I'm Geoffrey Brennan. +Twenty years spent moving from industrial design through UX leadership into product management — now leading AI product strategy for manufacturing software at CloudNC. I use that range to make better calls on what to build, and to earn the trust of the engineers who have to build it.

# How I work

I'm a product leader with more than 20 years' experience building products across AI, enterprise SaaS, manufacturing technology and industrial design. My career has taken an unusual path, from industrial design, through UX leadership, into product management, and each stage continues to shape how I approach product today.

I enjoy operating where technical complexity meets customer value. I'm as comfortable discussing machining physics with manufacturing engineers as I am running customer discovery sessions or presenting product strategy to an executive team. Being able to move between technical detail, user needs and commercial outcomes has become one of my greatest strengths.

Throughout my career I've focused on turning complex engineering challenges into products that customers trust, adopt and ultimately pay for.

I've led products through every stage of the lifecycle, from discovery and strategy to roadmap definition, delivery and go-to-market. Along the way I've worked closely with engineering, design, sales, marketing and customers to ensure the product solves the right problem—not just ships features.

Although I lead at a strategic level, I'm equally comfortable being hands-on when the situation calls for it. Whether that's building prototypes, shaping product design, analysing customer research or working through technical trade-offs with engineers, I enjoy getting close to the work.

If you'd like to learn more, I'd be delighted to talk.

## 20+

YEARS IN PRODUCT, DESIGN & ENGINEERING

## 4

INDUSTRIES — AI, HEALTHCARE SAAS,  
MANUFACTURING, INDUSTRIAL DESIGN

## 2

PATENTS — NAMED INVENTOR, US & CANADA

## 1000s

MANUFACTURERS AND DENTAL PRACTICES RUNNING  
SOFTWARE I HELPED BUILD

## CASE STUDY

# Teaching AI to think like a CNC programmer

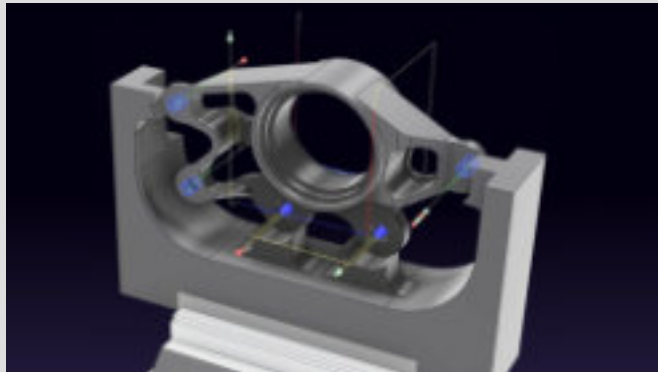
**ROLE** SENIOR PRODUCT MANAGER

**FOCUS** AI MANUFACTURING SOFTWARE

**COMPANY** CLOUDNC

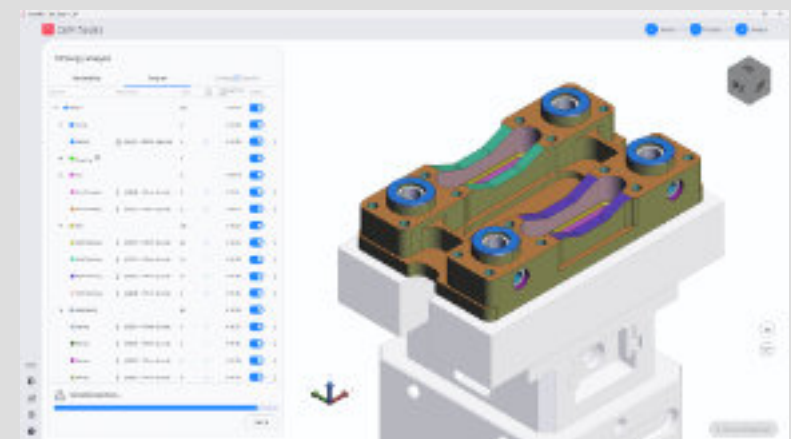
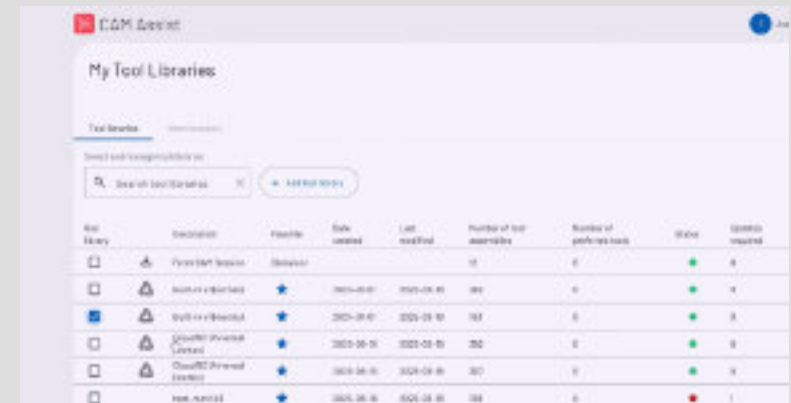
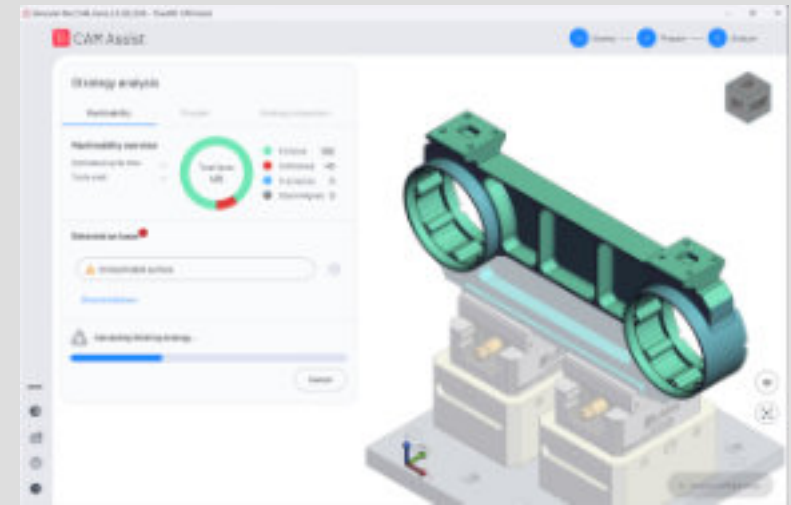
**OUTCOME** PRODUCTION AI PRODUCT FOR CNC WORKFLOWS

CloudNC is the clearest example of the work I do at the intersection of product strategy, technical depth and trust-building. The challenge was not simply to add AI to a workflow; it was to help CNC programmers adopt a system that could generate pragmatic machining strategies in a domain where the consequences of a bad decision are immediate and expensive. Every recommendation has to stand up to the realities of machine physics, tolerances and production constraints.



work directly with machinists, engineers, customers and AI researchers to define what value the product can credibly generate and how that value should surface inside the real production workflow. That means focusing on the points where automation reduces repetitive cognitive load without asking users to surrender judgement. It also means building system confidence through transparency, clear constraints and iterative feedback loops.

The result is a production-grade AI product that helps users move faster without compromising technical credibility. It is a strong example of the product leadership mode I use across domains: understand the underlying constraint, validate customer pain, translate that into a defensible roadmap, and keep the technical depth close to the product decision.



## The unglamorous system that unblocked millions in sales

**ROLE** PRODUCT MANAGER, UX

**COMPANY** CURVE DENTAL

**FOCUS** PRACTICE MANAGEMENT SAAS

**OUTCOME** FIVE TEAMS, ONE ROADMAP, SALES UNLOCK

Curve Dental's roles and permissions system was legacy, rigid, and a genuine liability. Practices were losing money to fraud that better access controls could have prevented, and deals were stalling in sales demos over it. I led this project across two roles, first as UX lead and then as the product manager who took it to general availability.



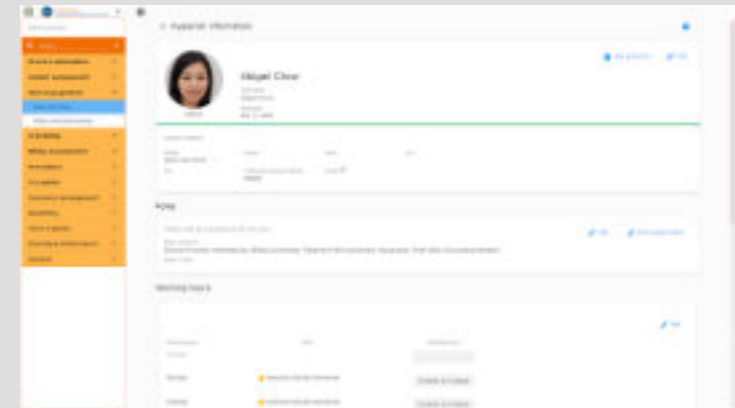
Extensive whiteboarding was undertaken throughout this project

### The Challenge

Curve Hero needed an extensive update to its user management and roles-and permissions system, one granular enough to work for a single dentist's office and a multi-site Dental Service Organisation alike. Dental practices exist to care for patients and grow the business; team members need to work within the functions relevant to their role, nothing more.

Dental fraud costs practices across North America millions of dollars a year, and the legacy system couldn't enforce meaningful separation of duties. Customers needed real granular control, the ability to create custom roles, and a rebuilt User Management experience, all while the team was simultaneously working on multi-clinic support and a new patient engagement module that this system had to integrate with.

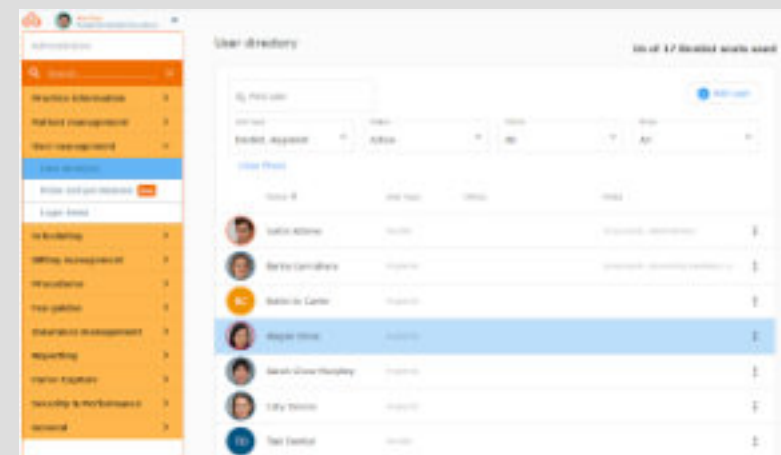
The biggest lesson wasn't about the design, it was about what happens when a SaaS product doesn't invest early in architectural-level decisions like this one. Left too long, they only get more expensive and disruptive to fix.



The rollout taught me something sharper: against design's recommendation, the implementation team activated the update by setting all users to read-only.

Practices were seriously disrupted; some dentists couldn't access clinical modules while actively treating patients. It's not a mistake I'd want to repeat, and it shaped how carefully I plan activation sequencing on every rollout since.

I also learned to take documentation seriously as part of the design, not an afterthought. The team was augmented with a technical writer for this project, and it visibly improved how well customers accepted the change. And I learned to hold a line: several internal voices pushed for a faster, "quick and dirty" version, and the validation work is what provided the evidence for that impactful product decision.



## The unglamorous system that unblocked millions in sales

**ROLE** PRODUCT MANAGER, UX

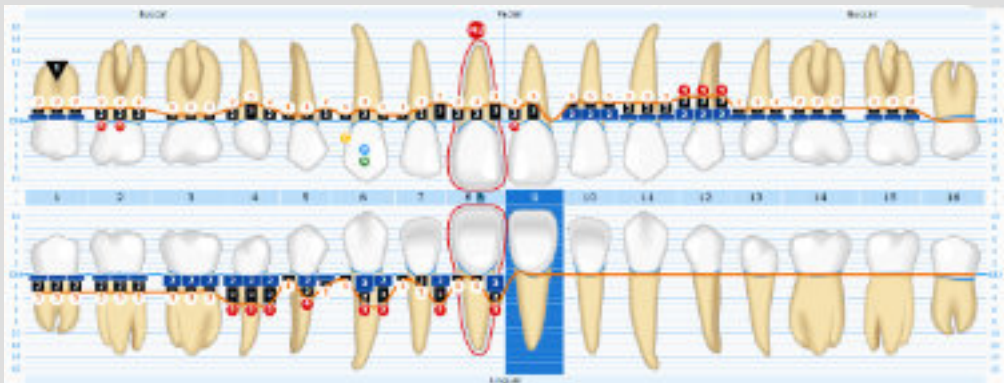
**FOCUS** CLINICAL WORKFLOW REDESIGN

**COMPANY** CURVE DENTAL

**OUTCOME** 10X USAGE INCREASE

Periodontal charting is a clinical workflow that is both extremely common and extremely demanding. Hygienists gather a large amount of data quickly, often under time pressure, and the workflow has to support multiple individual preferences without compromising speed or accuracy. The existing module in Curve Dental was built in Flash and had become technically obsolete. On top of that, it was confusing enough that users often reverted to paper records instead of entering data directly into the system.

The challenge was not simply to recreate an old feature in a new stack. The real task was to rebuild a workflow that actually matched how clinicians work. I led this effort as design lead, working directly with dental professionals to understand the variation in exam practices, the sequence of charting, and the type of data that mattered most. That process surfaced a critical insight: there was no single correct pathway for periodontal exams.



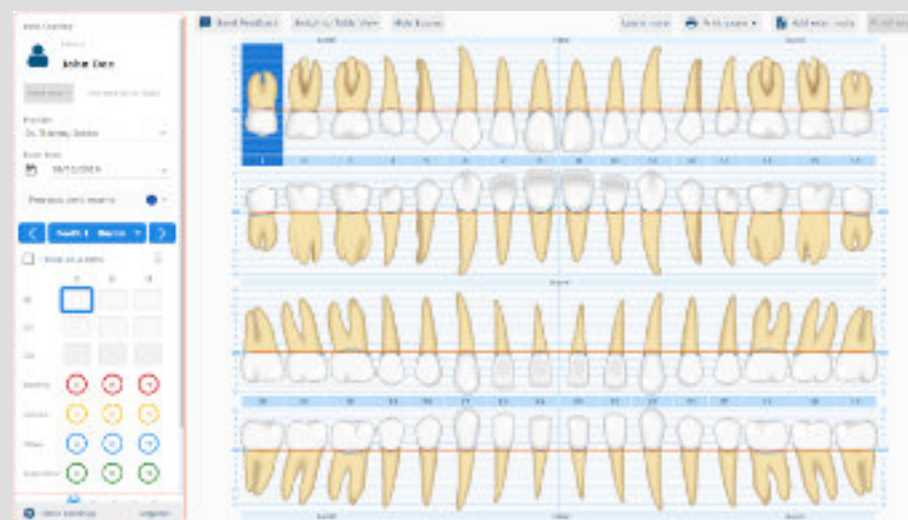
Hygienists disagreed on start conditions, order of measurement and which metrics mattered most, and the product had to accommodate those differences rather than forcing a single workflow onto the entire user base.

I designed a solution that paired anatomical accuracy with flexibility: a graphical mouth view for orientation, a tabular data-entry model for measurement, keyboard-first interactions for speed, and configurable exam behaviour that could adapt to different practice styles. I used SVG-based graphics and prototype testing to validate both the operational logic and the visual structure, then refined the product through alpha and beta feedback before general availability.



The result was a clear increase in product usage and a meaningful improvement in perceived quality. What had once been a feature users avoided became one of the product's defining strengths.

That experience reinforced my belief that the strongest product decisions come from close observation of real users and a willingness to design for variability rather than the mythical average customer.



## A few more things I've built



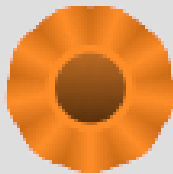
### Product Company Simulator

A strategy simulation that makes product, hiring, sales and engineering trade-offs visible over time.



### Case study - Survey wizard

A strategy simulation that makes product, hiring, sales and engineering trade-offs visible over time.



### Vessel Generator

A generative concept prototype exploring AI-assisted design and rapid visual experimentation in complex three dimensional domains.



### Case study - Billing update

A billing refresh designed to simplify repeated tasks and improve clarity for operationally-heavy finance workflows.



### Product Management Workbench

A planning workspace for early-stage prioritisation, discovery framing and clearer roadmap decisions.



### Prior work

A broader view of past product, design and strategy work across digital and physical product environments.



### UX Lens Prototype

An AI-assisted evaluation concept for surfacing UX issues, prioritising improvements and guiding better decisions.



These items hyperlink to external assets

PRODUCT LEADERSHIP

The common thread across these projects is not just UX or strategy in isolation, it is disciplined product leadership. I work by starting with the real constraint, validating assumptions with customers and stakeholders, then translating the underlying need into a product decision the team can execute confidently. I care about roadmap sequencing, trust, rollout quality and measurable outcomes, not just the appearance of a feature.

**Discovery before definition | Research that changes the plan |  
Designs that are operationally realistic  
Roadmaps built on real constraints | Delivery that protects trust  
Clear decisions, not noisy debate**

PRODUCT SKILLS

- Product Strategy & Vision
- Product Discovery
- Roadmapping
- AI Product Development
- Customer Research
- Product Lifecycle
- Management
- Stakeholder
- Management
- Agile Delivery

LEADERSHIP

- Cross-functional
- Leadership
- Executive
- Communication
- Team Development
- Workshop Facilitation
- Design Leadership
- Mentoring
- MVP Definition

DOMAINS & TOOLS

- Artificial Intelligence
- Enterprise SaaS
- Manufacturing & CAD/CAM
- Healthcare Software
- Industrial Design
- Jira
- Figma
- AI tools
- Amplitude
- Notion
- Visual Studio Code

HOW I THINK ABOUT AI IN PRODUCT



I don't think AI changes what good product management is. It changes how quickly you discover you're wrong. The fundamentals are the same ones I learned building software: understand the real constraint before you promise a capability, and never let the roadmap outrun what the system can reliably deliver.

What AI changes is the nature of failure. A CNC program either cuts the part correctly or it doesn't—the mistake is immediate, visible, and expensive. AI products fail differently. They can look convincing in a demo while quietly eroding user trust in production over weeks or months.

That makes trust a product requirement, not an afterthought. Every recommendation should be understandable, every limitation explicit, and very workflow designed to earn confidence rather than assume it. A customer won't commit to a product they can't trust.

That's why my background in industrial design and CAD/CAM isn't just an interesting career detour. It taught me that sophisticated technology only creates value when people understand its limits well enough to depend on it.

CONTACT

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